

Post-incident review PIR-2026-053

Data Warehouse: failed sign-ins

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 28 February 2026, Data Warehouse experienced failed sign-ins in production (US West) for about 110 minutes. Staff in the contact centre noticed the console was slow and told the service owner. Investigation found that a retry loop without backoff multiplied the load on a struggling downstream call.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw failed sign-ins for about 110 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:00 First signal received.
- 09:36 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:42 Likely cause identified.
- 10:06 Mitigation applied.
- 10:31 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a retry loop without backoff multiplied the load on a struggling downstream call. The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.